

9.5 KEY LANGUAGE GIVING ADVICE

You can also use modals to give advice based on facts. These can highlight the negative consequences of ignoring the advice.



You { **should**
ought to } wear a hat. It's very sunny.

General advice.



You **must** wear a hat or you'll get sunburned.

Strong advice; there are negative consequences if it is not followed.



9.6 OTHER WAYS TO GIVE ADVICE

You can also give advice using the phrases "If I were you..." and "You had better..." (usually contracted to "You'd better...").

This is a fixed phrase for giving advice as if you were the listener.

If I were you, I would wear a hat.

You'd better wear a hat.

This is used to give very strong advice. It may even suggest a threat.

TIP

You might hear people say, "If I was you..." but this is incorrect in formal English.



9.7 SAY THE SENTENCES OUT LOUD, CHOOSING THE CORRECT WORDS

The open air concert hall is amazing. You really **ought to** / **might** see it.



1

That snake is poisonous. You **must** / **could** go to the doctor about that bite or it'll get worse.



2

We **might** / **had better** go back to the boat. It's leaving soon and we don't want to miss it.



3

Perhaps you **must** / **could** go to France this summer. That would be nice.



4

Everyone says the castle is stunning and that we **must** / **could** see the view from the tower.

